meantime, El Al announced with pride that they found a pilot ready to fly the couple to Italy.

Thirty-seven out of forty reserve pilots of an elite air force unit will not report for training in protest against the judicial initiative. This kind of abstention is rapidly spreading to other units. Minister of Defense Gallant is worried enough to call for immediate talks. Netanyahu, Levin, and Rotman are supposedly in favor of dialogue with the opposition, yet they are still pushing their legislation forward at top speed. A poll held in the last few days shows that the coalition would lose seven seats if elections were held now.

The Knesset voted in a first reading for the law authorizing hospitals to prevent the bringing in of unleavened food during Passover. Lapid called it "religious coercion."

An internet campaign initiated by Arab personalities, which already had a million views among Israeli Arabs, is calling on them to participate in the protests against the judicial overhaul. It points out that the Arab population would be the first to feel the consequences of the proposed legislation. Massive Arab participation, although not welcome by some Jewish demonstrators, is urgent and would be a significant boost.

Monday, March 6

President Herzog announced that a compromise regarding the judicial overhaul was extremely close and that now was the time for political leaders to take over. In a response, unusually drafted in common, Lapid and Gantz praised the president for his efforts and declared their readiness for talks, but set as a precondition the pausing by Netanyahu of the legislation in the Knesset. Netanyahu has not yet reacted.

Two hundred physicians declared that they will not report for reserve duty. All former commanders of the air force to Netanyahu: stop the reform!